

FIELD READY LAB

2 HOURS

BEYOND CODE COLLECTIVE

TWO HOURS, EIGHT BLOCKS

0:00	SETTLE	Cowork open, folders connected
0:10	WHY YOU'RE HERE	One sentence each, on the board
0:20	INTRO TO AI	What an LLM is and isn't · six ways we fool ourselves · tokens
0:40	CLAUDE + COWORK 101	The loop, the four moves, one live task
0:55	WORKFLOWS VS AGENTS	Where does your workflow break today?
1:00	GET BUILDING	Three rounds: specify · build v0 · break it
1:45	DEMO	Four minutes each
1:55	FUTURE STATE + BACKLOG	What v1 needs

NEVER SHIP A RESULT YOU CAN'T EXPLAIN.

SPECIFY

READ

INTERROGATE

REJECT

VALIDATE, DON'T TRUST.

A LARGE LANGUAGE MODEL IS A VERY GOOD GUESSER.

It makes an educated guess. Sometimes excellent. Still
a guess.

IT IS NOT LOOKING THINGS UP.

IT IS NOT THINKING.

IT DOES NOT KNOW YOU.

DEEP KNOWLEDGE, ZERO UNDERSTANDING.

Imagine performing as Einstein in a play. You have the script, so you
know what to say. You have no idea what any of it means.

WHERE THE GUESSES COME FROM

1

PATTERN MAP

A map of every association in the data. Which words follow which.

2

REINFORCEMENT

Engineers mark outputs right or wrong. The system shapes future responses around the marks.

3

EXPERT-LED

A hundred mathematicians reconstruct the conceptual frameworks so outputs get more specific.

YOU ARE THE VERIFIER.

VERIFIABLE

Math. Science. Things with a checkable answer. The system can come back to you with something it confirmed.

EVERYTHING ELSE

Open-ended. Subjective. No way to verify. When it asks your opinion or offers more, it is using you to check its work.

Every failure you hit today comes from forgetting that. Confident when wrong. Agreeable when you are wrong. Personal when it is generic.

SIX WAYS OUR BRAINS MAKE VALIDATING HARD

ANTHROPOMORPHISM

Treating a non-human thing as if it had thoughts and feelings. Hardest with anything that talks back.

PATHETIC FALLACY

Giving emotion to something that has none. "It wanted to help." "It got confused."

ELIZA EFFECT

A 1966 script that reflected your words back. People insisted it understood them.

BARNUM EFFECT

Vague enough to fit anyone, so it feels personal. Horoscopes run on it.

COLD READING

General statements, watch the reaction, adjust. The audience supplies the specifics.

IMPLICATURE

We assume a speaker is truthful and relevant, so we read meaning into what is implied.

WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT

ANTHROPOMORPHISM

Say "the model" and "it." Ask: does the output match what I asked for?

PATHETIC FALLACY

Describe what the text did, not what the tool felt.

ELIZA EFFECT

Warmth in the output is not evidence of understanding.

BARNUM EFFECT

Would this be equally true of the next person who walked in?

COLD READING

Do not fill in the gaps for it. Make it be specific. Check the specifics.

IMPLICATURE

Read what it actually said. Do not credit it with what you inferred.

YOU NEED TO KNOW THESE ARE HAPPENING SO YOU CAN SEE WHEN IT'S HAPPENING TO YOU.

PASTE THIS. READ THE ANSWER OUT LOUD.

"Here are three sentences about how I work: I like to move fast, I care about the people I work with, and I sometimes take on too much. Based on this, tell me what kind of leader I am and what I should watch out for."

Warm. Plausible. Flattering. Everyone in the room will recognize themselves in it.

BARNUM • COLD READING
ANTHROPOMORPHISM • IMPLICATURE

NOW SET THE VOICE. RUN IT AGAIN.

"Be direct and specific. Don't flatter me. Only say things that follow from what I actually wrote, and tell me what you can't know from three sentences."

YOU DECIDE THE VOICE YOU GET BACK.

NOT SYCOPHANTIC.
VALIDATE, DON'T TRUST.

TOKENS, PARAMETERS, AND WHAT IS ACTUALLY LIVE

TOKENS

The pieces it reads and writes, roughly word-parts. "Business development" is about three. Everything counts toward a ceiling per conversation. Point at long spreadsheets, don't paste them.

NOTHING IS LIVE UNLESS YOU CONNECT IT

It does not see your Drive, your inbox, or today's date unless a tool gives it access. That is what Cowork does.

PARAMETERS

Billions of dials set once during training. Not a database of facts. A learned sense of what text follows what. Fluent about your industry, wrong about your numbers.

PRACTICAL RULE

Bring the facts, let the model bring the language. Put the real spreadsheet in the folder. Don't ask it to remember your leads; ask it to read them.

CLAUDE THAT WORKS INSIDE YOUR FILES AND APPS

1

YOU DESCRIBE THE GOAL

2

IT PLANS

3

YOU APPROVE

4

IT DOES

5

YOU CHECK

THE LAYER ON TOP

PROJECT

context that persists

SKILL

a repeatable way of doing a task

ARTIFACT

a thing it makes

CONNECTOR

an app it can reach

It asks before it writes to your files or sends anything. Nothing goes out without you.

LET'S BUILD

FORTY-FIVE MINUTES, THREE ROUNDS

1

15 min

SPECIFY

Fill the build card. Hand it to Cowork. Read the plan. Reject what you can't explain. Cut to one thing.

2

15 min

BUILD v0

Approve and let it build. Read as it produces. Run it once on real data.

3

15 min

BREAK IT

Feed it your "wrong looks like" case on purpose. Watch what it does. Ask it to tell you when it can't.

SAY THE GOAL, NOT THE MECHANISM

"Here is what I want to build. Before you build anything, write me a short plan: what you would create, what you need from me, and what you would not do yet."

A GOOD VO FOR TODAY

SHONDA

A lead tracker with fixed stages (sourced, first conversation, discovery, proposal drafted, submitted, won or lost), fixed fields, and one routine that reads the team's spreadsheet and your call notes and normalizes them, flagging rows it can't place.

CRISTINA

One intake path: drop a card photo, notes, or a voice memo transcript into a folder or Slack channel; Cowork extracts name, org, role, where met, what was discussed, next step; assigns a follow-up owner; posts one line to the team.

READ WHILE IT BUILDS

"Explain what you just did in two sentences."

"Simplify this so I can explain it."

Use both at least once this round.

When v0 exists, run it once on real data.

FEED IT THE CASE YOU KNOW WILL BREAK IT

A LEAD WITH NO STAGE

A DUPLICATE CONTACT

**A CARD PHOTO WITH NO
COMPANY NAME**

**A ROW IN THE WRONG
COLUMN**

Watch what it does. Ask it to handle that case, and to tell you when it cannot.

Stretch: Shonda, your editing style in five rules from a past proposal. Cristina, the follow-up Slack line in your voice, then correct it.

DEMO

FOUR MINUTES. THREE THINGS.

1

WHAT IT DOES

for the step that was broken

2

WHAT BROKE

and what happened

3

ONE PIECE YOU DIDN'T WRITE

but can explain (say it)

A BROKEN RUN EXPLAINED WELL BEATS A WORKING RUN EXPLAINED BADLY.

WHAT DOES V1 NEED?

One sentence. Write it on your card.

Then your backlog: everything you cut today that you still want. One per line.

FEEDBACK FOR THE PROGRAM

01 **WHERE DID IT DRAG?**

02 **WHICH OF THE SIX TERMS LANDED, AND WHICH FELL FLAT?**

03 **DID ANYONE REACH FOR THE TOOL BEFORE READING?**

04 **WAS 45 MINUTES RIGHT?**

05 **WHAT WOULD WE CUT OR ADD FOR A ROOM OF TWENTY STRANGERS?**

YAY!